changing stakeholder behavior. How can you encourage users to behave in a way that supports the business goals?

Once you've identified the principal stakeholders and understood their goals, you can think about the *capabilities* that you need to provide to meet these goals.

3.7 What do you need to build? Identify capabilities

A *capability* is the ability of your application to help stakeholders realize a business goal. Capabilities are high-level concepts that don't commit to a particular implementation. Because they're implementation-neutral, they give you a lot of flexibility as to how you build the underlying features.

I was once called in to help out a software development shop that specialized in the real estate market. They were trying to build a new application to help real estate agents provide property management services for property owners.

One of the aims of the application was to compete with and beat an existing rival product that already had a good hold on the market. After reading the competition's user's manual, the business owner listed the requirements that he wanted us to implement. It went along the following lines:

- Add a new property owner
- Archive a property owner
- Delete a property owner
- Send notifications to property owners
- ...

These requirements were quite possibly necessary for the application to work correctly, but it was less clear precisely what role they played in meeting the application's business goals. Remember, every feature a developer builds needs to be delivering value to the organization in some way (see figure 3.9). For example, why did they need to add a new property owner? How many new property owners would be added

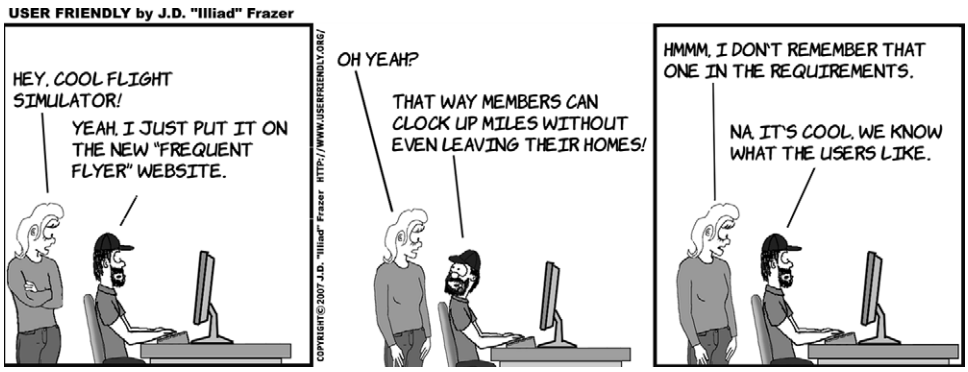


Figure 3.9 The ultimate purpose of any new feature is to deliver value to the organization. If it's not doing this in some way, it is probably waste.